ERA 18

The Home Front

1941 – 1945

Mobilization · opportunity · injustice

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did World War II transform American society at home—for better and worse?

KEY TERMS

The War Production Board · Rosie the Riveter · the Double V · Japanese internment · Korematsu

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 7.12 · AMSCO Ch. 7.12

TOTAL WAR REMAKES AMERICA—AGAIN

The Home Front

Mobilizing Industry



- The **War Production Board** converted factories to war output.
- American industry became the '**arsenal of democracy**'—out-producing all the Axis combined.
- War spending finally ended the **Great Depression**.

Selling the War

- The **Office of War Information** spread patriotic **propaganda**.
- Americans bought **war bonds** and accepted **rationing** of food, fuel, and rubber.
- The whole nation was mobilized for victory.



Rosie the Riveter

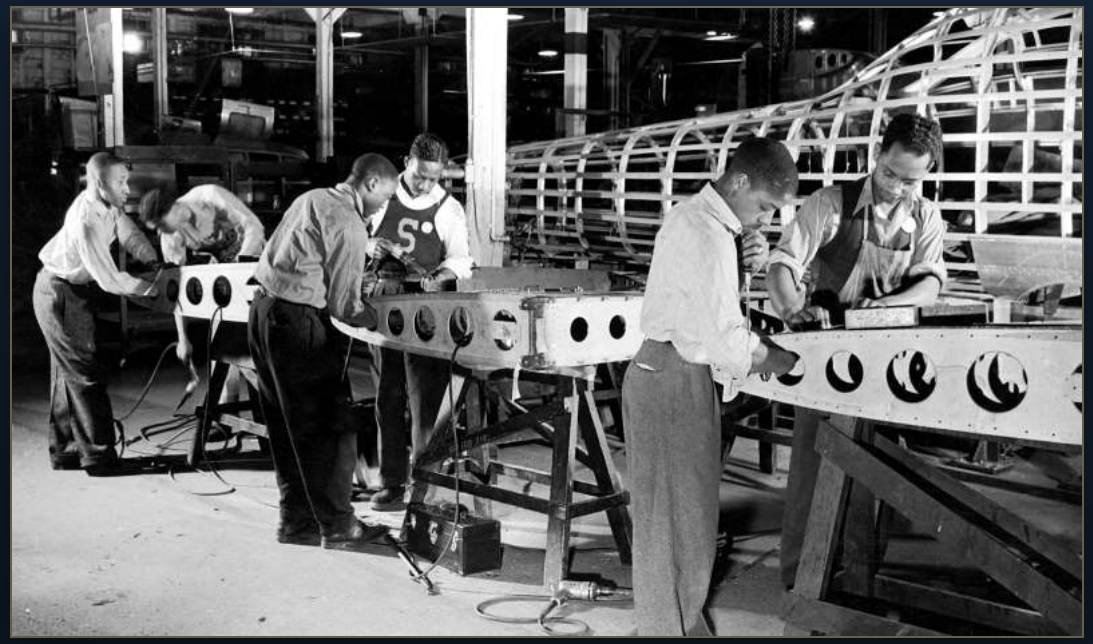


- With men at war, millions of women took factory and shipyard jobs.
- '**Rosie the Riveter**' became the symbol of women's war work.
- The experience reshaped women's role in the economy for good.

SECTION

Opportunity & Injustice

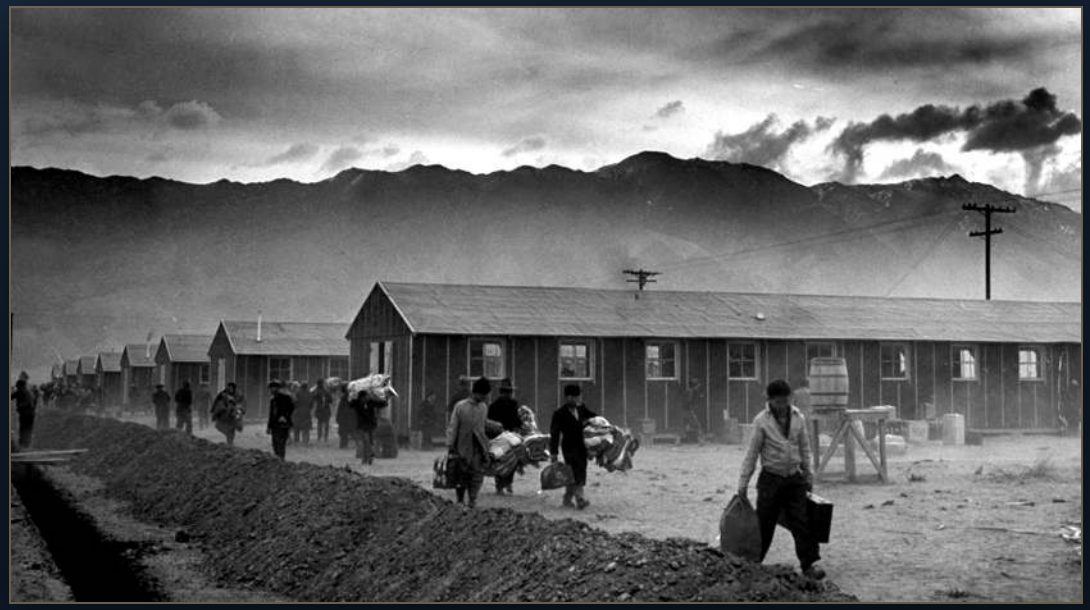
Black Americans & the Double V



- The **Great Migration** continued as Black workers took wartime jobs.
- The '**Double V**' campaign demanded victory abroad and over racism at home.
- **CORE** formed, and **Smith v. Allwright** struck down the all-white primary.

Japanese Internment

- After Pearl Harbor, fear and racism turned on Japanese Americans.
- **Executive Order 9066** forced 120,000—most of them U.S. citizens—into camps.
- In **Korematsu v. United States**, the Supreme Court upheld internment.



Others at War & Work

I

The Bracero Program

Brought Mexican laborers north to fill wartime farm and rail jobs.

II

Native Americans

Thousands served—including the **Navajo Code Talkers**—and worked in defense.

III

A Lasting Legacy

The **GI Bill** would send returning veterans to college and into new homes.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Home Front

1. The **War Production Board** made the U.S. the '**arsenal of democracy**'—and ended the Depression.
2. The war opened new opportunities for **women** (**Rosie the Riveter**) and **Black Americans** (the **Double V**).
3. It also brought grave injustice—the **internment** of Japanese Americans, upheld in **Korematsu**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Home Front

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how wartime mobilization finally ended the **Great Depression**.

COMPARISON

Compare the wartime experiences of **women** and **Black Americans**.

ARGUMENTATION

Was **Japanese internment** ever justified by 'military necessity'? Defend a claim.

Up next — **Class 52: The Early Cold War** (origins & containment)